

Why adding uncertainty into regional GVA is a good thing

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Or: how to avoid chasing vampires off cliff edges

In the movie ‘The Lost Boys’, David and his west-coast vampire buddies [race motorbikes across a misty landscape](#). Michael (as yet unaware of the blood-drinking habits of his new associates) tries to keep up with them. They egg him on - but then he spots the faint beam of a lighthouse, puts two and two together and barely avoids hurtling over a cliff edge.

One might say David was claiming ‘incredible certitude’ (Manski 2020) about the cliff’s location. “Don’t worry Micheal, it’s definitely, definitely miles from here.”

If there’s fog, what you do about that depends on what you think is going on / what else you feel certain about. But the fog matters, the fog itself is information. (i.e. fog near a cliff is different info to fog walking on an open moor).

Manski, Charles F. 2020. “The lure of incredible certitude.” *Economics and philosophy* 36 (2): 216245. <https://doi.org/10.1017/S0266267119000105>.